

**Burundi Digital Foundations Project (P176396)**

EASTERN AND SOUTHERN AFRICA | Burundi | IBRD/IDA | Investment Project Financing (IPF) | FY 2022 | Seq No: 6 |
 Archived on 13-May-2025 | ISR03987

Implementing Agencies: Ministère de la Communication, des Technologies de l'Information et des Médias (MINCOTIM),
 Ministère des Finances, du Budget et de la Planification Economique (MFBPE), Secrétariat Exécutif des Technologies de
 l'Information et de la Communication (SETIC)

1. OBJECTIVE**1.1 Development Objective**

Original Development Objective (Approved as part of Approval package on 22-Jun-2022)

To increase broadband internet access, especially to underserved communities, and improve government's capacity to deliver public services digitally.

Has the Development Objective been changed since Board Approval of the Project Objective?

Yes

Current Development Objective (Approved as part of Additional Financing package Seq. 1 on 10-Jan-2024)

To increase broadband internet access, especially to underserved communities, and improve government's capacity to manage resources more effectively and deliver public services digitally.

2. COMPONENTS

Name

1: Digital Access and Inclusion:(Cost 36,500,000.00)

2: Digital Public Service Delivery Enablers:(Cost 21,300,000.00)

3: Institutional Coordination & Project Management:(Cost 3,200,000.00)

4: Contingent Emergency Response:(Cost 0.00)

3. OVERALL RATINGS

Name	Previous	Current
Progress towards achievement of PDO	● Moderately Satisfactory	● Moderately Satisfactory



Overall Implementation Progress (IP)	● Moderately Satisfactory	● Moderately Satisfactory
Overall Risk Rating	● Substantial	● Substantial

4. KEY ISSUES & STATUS

4.1 Implementation Status and Key Decisions

The progress of the Burundi Digital Foundations Project, which has been under implementation for two and a half years with additional financing (AF) focused on modernizing public financial management (PFM) systems effective for one year, remains uneven, with the cumulative total disbursement reaching 15.4 percent and tangible results yet to be achieved. While the execution of the annual work plan and budget (AWPB) improved from 5 percent in November 2024 to 41.5 percent in April 2025, important TAs (including strategic documents for the digital and telecom sector) have been completed and PFM systems procurement has been launched, many important activities have registered significant delays. Overall, the pace of project implementation requires considerable acceleration for it to achieve its intended development impact by the project closure in 2028.

5. SYSTEMATIC OPERATIONS RISK-RATING TOOL

Risk Category	Rating at Approval Approval Package - 22 Jun 2022	Last Approved Rating ISR Seq. 05 - 11 Nov 2024	Proposed Rating
Political and Governance	● Substantial	● Substantial	● Substantial
Macroeconomic	● High	● Substantial	● Substantial
Sector Strategies and Policies	● Substantial	● Substantial	● Substantial
Technical Design of Project or Program	● Moderate	● Substantial	● Substantial
Institutional Capacity for Implementation and Sustainability	● Substantial	● Substantial	● Substantial
Fiduciary	● Substantial	● Substantial	● Substantial
Environment and Social	● Moderate	● Moderate	● Moderate
Stakeholders	● Substantial	● Substantial	● Substantial



Other	● Substantial	● Substantial	● Substantial
Overall	● Substantial	● Substantial	● Substantial



6. RESULTS

6.1 PDO Indicators by PDO Outcomes

To increase broadband internet access, especially to underserved communities								
Indicator Name	Baseline		Actual (Previous)		Actual (Current)		Closing Period	
	Value	Month/Year	Value	Date	Value	Date	Value	Month/Year
People using broadband internet (new use) (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2024			0	30-Apr-2025	475,000	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		WB interventions aiming to expand broadband coverage in rural areas and offer broadband internet access to populations is about to start. The population that will be affected by these interventions is estimated at 786,347 people. Given that 40% of the Burundian population is under 15 years. We consider the potential users of broadband internet to 60% of the affected population and rounded it up to 475,000 people.					
People using broadband internet (new use) - Female (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2024			0	30-Apr-2025	240,000	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		Burundi female population is 50.3% of the overall population, so the same share is applied to the overall target of 475,000.					
People using broadband internet (new use) - Youth (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2025			0	30-Apr-2025	166,250	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		People aged between 15 and 34 represent 35% of the population in Burundi, so this share is applied to the 786,347 people (population expected to be affected by the project interventions focused on connectivity)					
People using broadband internet (inferred use) (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2024					0	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		The project doesn't have any investments in the first or middle mile. Hence, improvements in inferred use cannot be attributed to the project, so the indicator is not relevant					
	0	Sep/2024					0	Jun/2028



People using broadband internet (inferred use) - Female (Number of people) CRI	Comments on achieving targets		The project doesn't have any investments in the first or middle mile. Hence, improvements in inferred use cannot be attributed to the project, so the indicator is not relevant					
People using broadband internet (inferred use) - Youth (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2025					0	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		The project doesn't have any investments in the first or middle mile. Hence, improvements in inferred use cannot be attributed to the project, so the indicator is not relevant					
People using broadband internet (enhanced use) (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2025					0	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		While the project includes a TA for the telecom regulator (including on developing a new five-year strategy, improving spectrum management, enhancing quality of service (QoS) monitoring, etc.), it is not possible to ascertain the impact of these activities on enhanced down-/upload speeds, lower latency, and lower prices. Hence, enhanced use cannot be easily attributed to the project interventions, so the indicator is not relevant.					
People using broadband internet (enhanced use) - Female (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2025					0	
	Comments on achieving targets		While the project includes a TA for the telecom regulator (including on developing a new five-year strategy, improving spectrum management, enhancing quality of service (QoS) monitoring, etc.), it is not possible to ascertain the impact of these activities on enhanced down-/upload speeds, lower latency, and lower prices. Hence, enhanced use cannot be easily attributed to the project interventions, so the indicator is not relevant					
People using broadband internet (enhanced use) - Youth (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2025					0	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		While the project includes a TA for the telecom regulator (including on developing a new five-year strategy, improving spectrum management, enhancing quality of service (QoS) monitoring, etc.), it is not possible to ascertain the impact of these activities on enhanced down-/upload speeds, lower latency, and lower prices. Hence, enhanced use cannot be easily attributed to the project interventions, so the indicator is not relevant					
	10.00	Dec/2021	20.30	30-Sep-2024	24.32	31-Dec-2024	25.00	Jun/2027



Broadband penetration rate: share of population with an active broadband internet subscription (mobile and fixed) (Percentage)	Comments on achieving targets		The data reported by the regulator ARCT’s observatory of the telecom market for this indicator does not follow now the same methodology as during preparation as the statistical department now includes 2G subscriptions. The data reported here is from WB (2024) - latest available for Burundi.					
Of which women (Percentage)	0.00		0.00		0.00		60.00	
	Comments on achieving targets		There is no data on this indicator in the data sources used (ITU, WB). The indicator could be measure with a survey. The team will make sure to conduct at least one survey before the end of the project.					
Of which rural (Percentage)	0.00		0.00		0.00		60.00	
	Comments on achieving targets		There is no data on this indicator in the data sources used (ITU, WB). The indicator could be measure with a survey. The team will make sure to conduct at least one survey before the end of the project.					
To improve government's capacity to deliver public services digitally								
Indicator Name	Baseline		Actual (Previous)		Actual (Current)		Closing Period	
	Value	Month/Year	Value	Date	Value	Date	Value	Month/Year
People using digitally enabled services (new services) (Number of people) CRI	0	Dec/2021			0	30-Apr-2025	350,000	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		Only a very small subcomponent (with downstream investments budgeted at US\$2.7 million and contingent on upstream TAs) targets the digitalization of selected G2G, G2P, and G2B services and applications, all of which will represent new services. We anticipate that roughly 5% of the adult population of Burundi aged 15-64 (currently estimated at 7 mln people) will start using digitalized services.					
People using digitally enabled services (new services) - Female (Number of people) CRI					0	30-Apr-2025	176,050	
	Comments on achieving targets		Burundi female population is 50.3% of the overall population.					
					0	30-Apr-2025	122,500	Jun/2028



People using digitally enabled services (new services) - Youth (Number of people) CRI	Comments on achieving targets		People aged between 15 and 34 represent 35% of the population in Burundi.					
People using digitally enabled services (enhanced services) (Number of people) CRI	0						0	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		Burundi doesn't have partially digitalized services (quasi all services are currently paper based). This sub-indicator is hence not relevant.					
People using digitally enabled services (enhanced services) - Female (Number of people) CRI	0						0	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		Burundi doesn't have partially digitalized services (quasi all services are currently paper based). This sub-indicator is hence not relevant.					
People using digitally enabled services (enhanced services) - Youth (Number of people) CRI	0						0	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		Burundi doesn't have partially digitalized services (quasi all services are currently paper based). This sub-indicator is hence not relevant.					
Shared infrastructure and services operationalized by Government that enable digital public services delivery (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	8.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		No change since baseline. First results are expected in FY26.					
To improve the Government's capacity to manage resources more effectively								
Indicator Name	Baseline		Actual (Previous)		Actual (Current)		Closing Period	
	Value	Month/Year	Value	Date	Value	Date	Value	Month/Year
Level of irregular expenditures on the yearly budget execution report (Amount(USD))	19,000,000.00	Jun/2023	19,000,000.00	30-Sep-2024	19,000,000.00	31-Dec-2024	1,000,000.00	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		Indicator is measured by the end of fiscal year each year (July).					



Share of tax audits selected by data-informed practices (Percentage)	0.00	Jun/2023	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Sep-2024	70.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		No change since baseline. Trainings of OBR officials held within FY25 are expected to improve performance of the indicator in FY26.					

6.2 Intermediate Results Indicators by Components

1: Digital Access and Inclusion								
Indicator Name	Baseline		Actual (Previous)		Actual (Current)		Closing Period	
	Value	Month/Year	Value	Date	Value	Date	Value	Month/Year
People using broadband internet – Youth (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2024	0	30-Sep-2024	0	30-Apr-2025	166,250	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		People aged between 15 and 34 represent 35% of the population in Burundi. Thus, Youth (15 to 34) using broadband internet is set to 275,000 (35% of the affected population)					
People using broadband internet – Female (Number of people) CRI	0	Sep/2024	0	30-Sep-2024	0	30-Apr-2025	240,000	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		Burundi female population is 50.3% of the overall population. So set the target for Female using internet to 240,000 out of 475,000.					
Adoption of new gender-inclusive and climate-smart broadband strategy that will strengthen competition (Yes/No)	No	Dec/2021	No	30-Apr-2024	No	30-Apr-2025	Yes	Jun/2027
Price of 1 GB of mobile data per month, as a percentage of GNI per capita (Percentage)	13.60	Dec/2021	10.50	30-Sep-2023	10.40	31-Dec-2024	6.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		Data source: ITU Data Hub : https://datahub.itu.int/data/?e=BDI&c=701&i=34617					
Operationalization of an effective Quality of Service (QoS) monitoring system incl.	No	Dec/2021	No	30-Apr-2024	Yes	30-Apr-2025	Yes	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		A Quality of Service monitoring system has been introduced and operationalized by the telecom regulator.					



a related consumer complaints mechanism (Yes/No)								
Beneficiaries receiving training in digital literacy to enable usage of basic digital devices and services under the project (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Apr-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	150,000.00	Jun/2027
Of which persons with disabilities (Number)	0.00		0.00		0.00		3,000.00	
	Comments on achieving targets		Number of persons with disabilities enrolled in digital literacy programs under the project.					
Number of women receiving training in digital literacy to enable usage of basic digital devices and services under the project (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Apr-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	90,000.00	Jun/2027
Beneficiaries able to access a broadband compatible device through the project (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Apr-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	150,000.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		The digital device access program has not started yet					
Of which persons with disabilities (Number)	0.00		0.00		0.00		3,000.00	
	Comments on achieving targets		Number of individual persons with disabilities able to access a broadband compatible device partly or fully financed by the project.					
Number of women able to access a broadband compatible device through the project (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Apr-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	90,000.00	Jun/2027
	25.00	Dec/2021	25.00	30-Sep-2023	53.20	31-Dec-2024	40.00	Jun/2027



Broadband network coverage rate: share of population with mobile broadband network coverage. (Percentage)	Comments on achieving targets		The broadband coverage is mainly 3G coverage. 4G coverage currently stands at 32.18%					
Rural provinces served by broadband networks with 40 percent or higher coverage of population (Number)	1.00		1.00		1.00		7.00	
	Comments on achieving targets		The new decentralization strategy reduces the number of provinces to 5 (effective on July 1, 2025). It's thus probable that, in FY26, all the new provinces will meet the requirement of having 3G and above mobile network coverage of the population that is higher than 40 percent.					
Private sector investment mobilized under the project (Amount(USD))	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Apr-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	11,000,000.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		The mobilization of private investment in broadband infrastructure is about to start. Results are expected in the next ISR					
Time taken to process human resources services for civil servants (Percentage)	0.00	Jun/2023	0.00	30-Apr-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	20.00	Jun/2028
2: Digital Public Service Delivery Enablers								
Indicator Name	Baseline		Actual (Previous)		Actual (Current)		Closing Period	
	Value	Month/Year	Value	Date	Value	Date	Value	Month/Year
Adoption of Government Enterprise Architecture and interoperability framework for Government IT infrastructure (Yes/No)	No	Dec/2021	No	30-Sep-2024	No	30-Apr-2025	Yes	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		No change since baseline due to significant delays in launching associated activity, which is now expected to be completed in FY26.					
Publication of a cybersecurity and cybercrime national strategy and roadmap (Yes/No)	No	Oct/2023	No	30-Sep-2024	No	30-Apr-2025	Yes	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		The technical assistance aiming to develop a national cybersecurity strategy and roadmap has been completed with the validation workshop held in December 2024. However, the publication of the strategy is still to be achieved (pending submission and approval by the Council of Ministers).					



Publication of a Data Strategy and Action Plan (Yes/No)	No	Dec/2021	No	30-Sep-2024	No	30-Apr-2025	Yes	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		The work has been launched and expected to be completed by the end of FY25 (publication might happen in Q1, FY26).					
Data controllers and processors registered with the new Data Protection Authority (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	100.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		While the draft law on data protection and draft decree on data protection authority (DPA) have been elaborated; none have yet been adopted and the operationalization of the DPA is yet to be achieved (expected in FY26).					
Volume of digital payment transactions transmitted through the upgraded payments switch (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	1,500,000.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		No change since baseline as BRB has revised its strategy and has repatriated the National Switch. The project is not supporting any switch-focused activities.					
Civil servants trained in management or use of digital systems and infrastructure (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	500.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		Targeted change management activities have started with support from the World Bank and big-scale activities have just been launched by the recipient (including IFMIS and ITAS). The indicator is expected to increase significantly in FY26.					
Of which women (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	300.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		Targeted change management activities have started with support from the World Bank and big-scale activities have just been launched by the recipient (including IFMIS and ITAS). The indicator is expected to increase significantly in FY26.					
Quarterly visits on the Government e-services portal (Number)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	15,000.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		No change from baseline. The work in the e-gov portal hasn't started yet and is only expected to be launched in FY26 with impact expected in the second half of 2026 calendar year.					
National Budget prepared through the new IFMIS (Yes/No) (Yes/No)	No	Jun/2023	No	30-Sep-2024	No	30-Apr-2025	Yes	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		No change from baseline. IFMIS acquisition process is ongoing. It is expected that the IFMIS will be used to prepare and execute the FY26/27 budget.					
	0.00	Jun/2023	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	4.00	Jun/2028

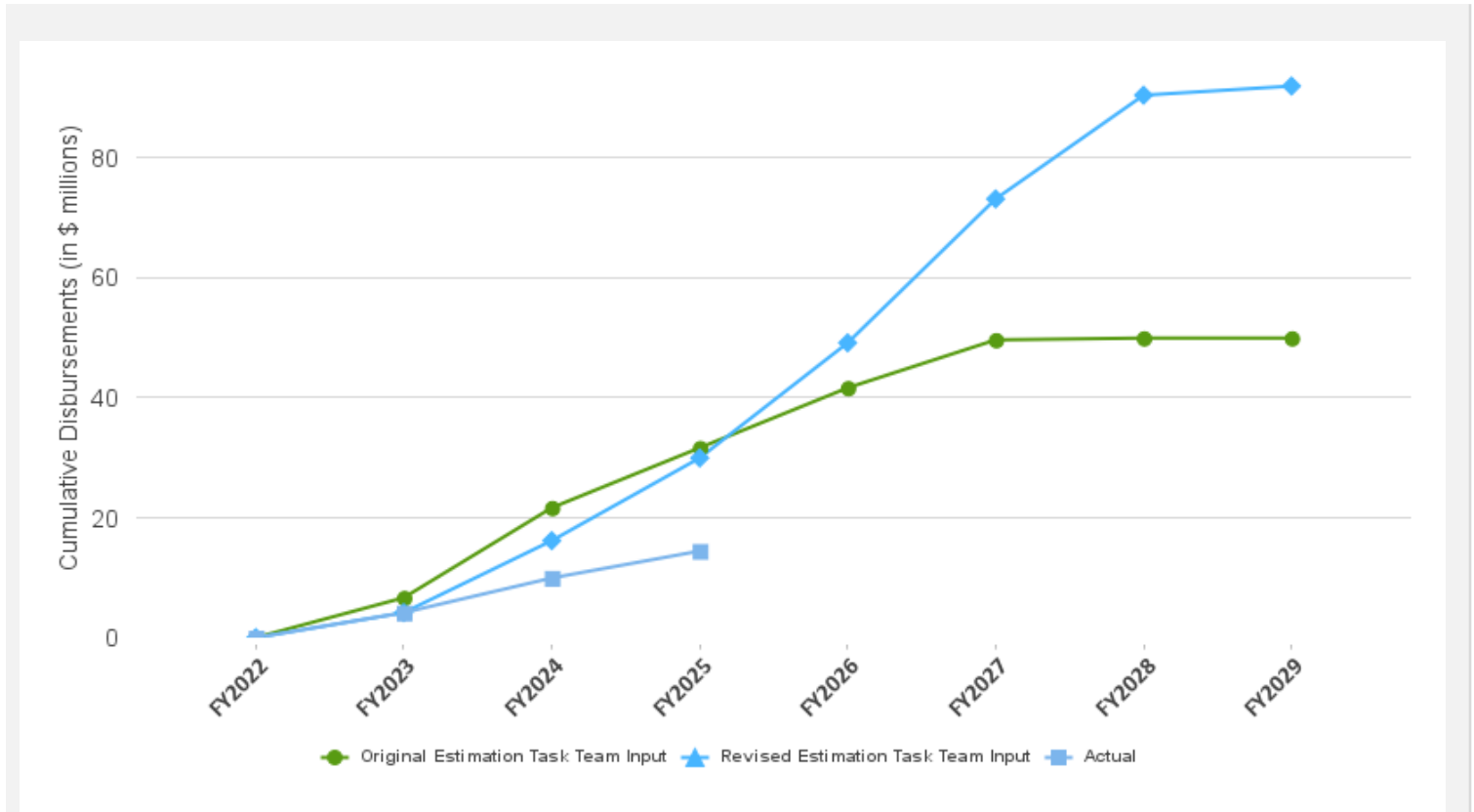


Tax services covered by the ITAS (Number)	Comments on achieving targets		No change from baseline. ITAS rollout is expected to conclude in September 2025 hence impact on this indicator in only expected in FY26.					
Percentage of (MDAs) human resource units within sectoral ministries connected to the central HRMIS system (Percentage)	0.00	Jun/2023	0.00	30-Sep-2024	0.00	30-Apr-2025	100.00	Jun/2028
	Comments on achieving targets		No change from baseline. The choice of either an upgrade or a new IT solution has still been done. The WB team is exploring the possibility to cancel the activity.					
3: Institutional Coordination & Project Management								
Indicator Name	Baseline		Actual (Previous)		Actual (Current)		Closing Period	
	Value	Month/Year	Value	Date	Value	Date	Value	Month/Year
Grievances registered that receive an adequate response within 30 days (Percentage)	0.00	Dec/2021	0.00	30-Sep-2024	67	30-Apr-2025	100.00	Jun/2027
	Comments on achieving targets		While GRM is active and available online and no complaints have been received though the online platform, three complaints have been received by the PIU outside of the platform: Two have been treated and closed with satisfaction within 30 days; one is ongoing review by the Ministry of Justice. This explains the percentage of 67% (i.e., 2 out of 3).					



7. DATA ON FINANCIAL PERFORMANCE

7.1 Cumulative Disbursements



7.2 Disbursements (by loan)

Loan/Credit/TF	Status	Original	Revised	Cancelled	Disbursed	Undisbursed	% Disbursed
IDA-E0930	Effective	50.00	49.92	0.00	9.08	40.79	18.20%
IDA-E2820	Effective	42.00	43.27	0.00	5.37	37.77	12.45%

7.3 Key Dates (by loan)

Loan/Credit/TF	Status	Approval	Signing	Effectiveness	Orig. Closing	Rev. Closing
IDA-E0930	Effective	22-Jun-2022	01-Sep-2022	28-Feb-2023	30-Aug-2027	30-Aug-2028



IDA-E2820 Effective 10-Jan-2024 25-Jan-2024 17-May-2024 30-Aug-2028 30-Aug-2028

8. KEY DATES

Key Events	Planned	Actual
Approval	22-Jun-2022	22-Jun-2022
Effectiveness	28-Feb-2023	28-Feb-2023
Mid-Term Review No. 01	19-Jan-2026	
Operation Closing/Cancellation	30-Aug-2028	

9. RESTRUCTURING HISTORY

10. ASSOCIATED OPERATION(S)

There are no associated operations